

Activity 7: Recover a Logistics Service Relationship

Course TGS-2023020567 · K4 · K5 · A4

Objective

Use listening, empathy, questions and emotional regulation with a defensive service provider.

Real-world use-case basis

Real-world use case: service-recovery negotiations combine operational facts, attribution disputes, emotion, capacity constraints and future relationship value.

Scenario

LionCity Homeware's logistics provider missed 18% of delivery windows during a campaign. Customer complaints rose, but the provider says inaccurate forecasts and late order changes caused most failures. The account manager becomes defensive when service credits are mentioned. Switching providers before the year-end peak is risky.

Primary source

<https://www.betterup.com/blog/negotiation-skills>

Training assumptions

- The SLA target is 95% on-time delivery; actual performance was 82% for six weeks.
- Thirty percent of late orders were changed by LionCity after the agreed cut-off.
- Service credits could total SGD 42,000, but capacity for the peak period is more valuable.
- Both parties can share weekly forecast and capacity data under confidentiality controls.

Questions

1. Which facts, interpretations and emotions must be separated?
2. What open and diagnostic questions could reveal the failure system?
3. How can the team acknowledge impact without accepting unsupported blame?
4. What reciprocal recovery commitments create measurable improvement?

Expected output

A structured recovery meeting record and conditional service-improvement agreement.

Acceptance test

The record distinguishes fact from blame, captures both parties' interests and assigns measurable reciprocal actions with owners and dates.